water, roads and drainage, communications, tourism, social infrastructure and sanitation sectors, and rehabilitating civil war-related infrastructure, and has put US$150 million into the Banco BAI financial services and US$80 million into housing projects. The DBSA is also financing part of the country's increase in electricity-generating capacity from the present 1 200 MW to 8 400 MW by 2025.

In Lesotho, the DBSA disbursed about R740 million to Tsepong, a public–private partnership (PPP) consortium led by South African private hospital and healthcare group Netcare, to construct, upgrade and operate a new public hospital at Botshabelo in Maseru. Netcare, a South African company, led the consortium; in Zimbabwe, the share Netcare held of a similar project was 30%, with 70% reserved for the state-owned enterprise.

A bias to privatisation appears to be growing. In Zambia, the DBSA provided a loan of US$262 million to the Zambian Road Development Fund Agency for the rehabilitation of five priority roads, three of which form part of the Trans African Highways route running from Cape Town to the DRC's Katanga Province and onwards to Kinshasa. DBSA financed the PPP Kasumbalesa Border Post between the DRC and Zambia, which was meant to reduce costly delays of overland freight traffic, but which suffered debilitating implementation crises.

Similar PPP financing of R1.4 billion was provided to Infralink Pty Ltd – a joint venture between the Zimbabwe National Road Administration and Group Five Limited of South Africa – to rehabilitate roads and implement tolling of existing national routes, covering 801.5 kilometres on an east-west axis from Plumtree through Bulawayo to Harare and then Mutare.

Critiques of the DBSA relate partly to its facilitation of corporate takeover of infrastructure. In addition, because of the small portion of funding going to the region compared to South Africa, there is a perception that the bank is only regional in name. In 2012, around 14% of its assets were in the region outside South Africa, with future SADC lending anticipated at US$2.3 billion.

That perception is also restated in South Africa's own National Development Plan: 'SA is critically under-represented in organisations like the African Development Bank and SADC. The latter is critical as South Africa is a major funder of the group … To fulfil South Africa's obligations in the BRICS and in the region, the DBSA should be strengthened institutionally.'

But did the DBSA deserve the R7.9 billion in new funding in 2013? This was a well-grounded complaint by SADC deputy executive secretary João Samuel Caholo less than a year before: 'There is resentment towards the DBSA in certain quarters because it is in South Africa, and South Africa is the only shareholder. SADC has no say in what the DBSA does and although the bank does work on